WEEKLY MARKETS SUMMARY

Week of October 26–30, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · October 2026

NASDAQ 100 — WEEKLY CHG.
−1.98%
28,958 → 28,385 pts | −3.5% on Friday

GOLD (FUT.) — WEEKLY CHG.
−2.72%
$4,008 → $3,899 | −3.7% on Friday

BITCOIN — WEEKLY CHG.
−5.68%
$81,078 → $76,474 | Binance hack

ARGENTINA EMBI — WEEKLY CHG.
+34 bps
707 → 741 bps* | peak of 765 on Monday

The week ended with a broad technology sell-off that left the Nasdaq 100 down 3.5% on Friday and 2.0% on the week, and the Nasdaq with its worst month since March 2025 (−5.3% in October). The trigger was doubt over the return on artificial-intelligence investment: Alphabet had its worst day ever on Thursday, and Intel (−28.6%) and Amazon reported guidance and cash flows on Friday that fed worries about how AI spending is financed. The Fed held at 3.75%–4.00% with two votes in favor of a hike, Q3 GDP grew 3.4% and PCE reached 3.6%, so the market assigns about 90% to a December hike; even so, the 10-year Treasury ended the week at 4.93%, with safe-haven demand in the final session. Gold gave up 2.7% and Bitcoin 5.7% —after the Binance hack of more than $6 billion— while Brent returned to $113–116 on Hormuz. In Argentina, Lula's re-election hit Brazil (Bovespa −13.9% on Monday) and spilled over to local assets: country risk touched 765 points and closed the week at 741 on the last official reading (+34 bps), the MSCI Merval fell five sessions in a row and 10.0% in pesos, and the MEP rose 0.7% to $1,574.



Trick or treat! A spooky week for markets

Halloween Edition · October 30, 2026

1. Timeline of the Week

WEEKLY TIMELINE	
Mon 10/26	Lula won Sunday's runoff and Brazil had its worst day since 1999: the Bovespa fell 13.9% and the real 8%, with long rates at highs since 2015 and DI contracts above 15%; the Treasury bought back bonds to calm the market. In the US, the S&P 500 rose 0.70% to 7,676.77, the Nasdaq 100 1.09% and the Dow 0.28%, with the VIX at 18.39, after Anthropic's S-1 for its public offering and a $63 billion financing with Broadcom; Meta placed $35 billion of shares. Oil near $115 while Trump chooses between a deal with Iran and resuming the offensive. In Argentina, the EMBI jumped 58 bps to 765, the CCL closed at $1,681 with a 7.5% gap and the BCRA ended a 19-session buying streak.
Tue 10/27	Wall Street rebounded: S&P 500 +0.60% at 7,722.60, Nasdaq 100 +1.29% at 29,651.44 and Dow +0.03%, with the VIX at 17.52. The real recovered to R$5.34 although global banks are cutting Brazil exposure and the market is demanding the finance minister's name. Israel voted, in a tight race. Brent traded above $111 and European gas (TTF) topped €97/MWh; in the UK, 30-year gilts touched 6%, the highest since 1998, ahead of the budget. In Argentina, the EMBI retreated 12 bps to 753; GD30D closed at 56.06 cents (+0.32%) and GD35D at 72.86 (+1.04%).
Wed 10/28	The Fed held at 3.75%–4.00%, with two votes in favor of a hike, and the market assigns about 90% to a December hike; Warsh avoided explicit guidance. S&P 500 +0.28% at 7,743.98, Nasdaq 100 +0.55% at 29,813.16 and Dow +0.19%; the 10-year closed at 5.05%. Microsoft and Oracle rose on visible returns on their AI investment, while Alphabet fell 7% after the close despite record spending. UK Chancellor Healey's budget was modest and energy-focused; the Bank of Canada raised its rate. In Argentina, the IMF approved the third review at staff level ($900 million, subject to Board approval), the Treasury rolled over 106% of ARS 10 trillion in maturities and the EMBI rose 10 bps to 763; the BCRA did not buy for a third straight session.
Thu 10/29	Q3 US GDP grew 3.4% annualized (est. 3.2%) and PCE reached 3.6% (core 3.1% y/y). Alphabet had the worst day in the company's history, losing about $500 billion in market value on record AI spending: Nasdaq 100 −1.38% at 29,402.51, S&P 500 −0.30% at 7,720.39 and Dow −0.25%. The ECB held rates and Lagarde will leave on February 7; the Bank of Japan also held and declared its 2% inflation goal met. Brent rose 1.4% to $116.53 after the attack on a tanker in Hormuz and TTF again topped €100. In Argentina, the EMBI fell 22 bps to 741, the last official reading of the week, and the global bonds rose (GD30D +0.87%, GD35D +1.39%), although the Merval fell for a fourth day.
Fri 10/30	Heavy tech selling: Nasdaq 100 −3.46% at 28,384.85, S&P 500 −1.82% at 7,580.07 and Dow −1.09% at 51,770.31; the Nasdaq Composite had its worst day since June and the VIX rose 12.9% to 19.42. Intel fell 28.6%, its largest drop since 1974, on weak guidance; Amazon lost 1.4% with negative free cash flow of $42.4 billion over twelve months and Nvidia 4.2%. Bitcoin lost 5% after a Binance hack of more than $6 billion; gold fell 3.7% to $3,899 and the 10-year closed at 4.93% (−6 bps on the week). The Kospi lost 3.5% and the Nikkei 2.1%; Brent rose 2.4% to $113.43 and Exxon and Chevron gained nearly 2%. In Argentina, the MSCI Merval fell 2.6% to 92,075 and GD30D closed at $0.5553 (−0.66%), with AL30 at ARS 841.10 (−0.76%).

2. Weekly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 10/23. Reference close: Friday 10/30.

Asset	Close Fri 10/23	Close Fri 10/30	Weekly chg.
S&P 500	7,623.68	7,580.07	−0.57%
Nasdaq 100	28,957.53	28,384.85	−1.98%
Dow Jones	52,215.16	51,770.31	−0.85%
VIX	19.45	19.42	−0.15%
UST 10Y	4.99%	4.93%	−6 bps
WTI (fut.)	$103.27	$102.95	−0.31%
Gold (fut.)	$4,007.90	$3,898.90	−2.72%
Bitcoin	$81,078.04	$76,473.98	−5.68%
EMBI Global (Argentina)	707 bps	741 bps*	+34 bps

Argentina local market	Close Fri 10/23	Close Fri 10/30	Weekly chg.
GD30D	$0.5647	$0.5553	−1.66%
GD35D	$0.7388	$0.7173	−2.91%
MSCI Merval (pesos)	102,332.57**	92,075.47	−10.02%
MSCI Merval (USD MEP)	65.50	58.51	−10.67%
USD MEP (AL30)	$1,562.27	$1,573.62	+0.73%

** Argentina EMBI: 741 bps is the last official close published by JP Morgan (Thursday 10/29); the 10/30 figure will be released on Monday. The week's high was 765 bps on 10/26. ** MSCI Merval: both dates from the same source (IOL); last week's report cited 102,277.62 per the press. GD30D, GD35D, AL30 and AL30D verified on Balanz Productores at the 10/30 close; USD MEP = AL30 / AL30D. WTI refers to the December contract; gold and Bitcoin from the same source for both dates.*

3. Key Drivers of the Week

KEY DRIVERS	
AI passes the financing test: Alphabet, Intel and Amazon leave the Nasdaq with its worst month since March 2025	On Thursday Alphabet had its worst trading day ever, losing about $500 billion in market value on record AI spending, and on Friday Intel (−28.6%, its worst drop since 1974) and Amazon, with negative free cash flow of $42.4 billion over twelve months, reinforced the doubt. The Nasdaq 100 fell 3.5% on the day and 2.0% on the week; the Nasdaq closed October at −5.3%, while the Dow gained 1.5% on the month. The market is discriminating: Microsoft and Oracle rose on visible returns on their investment, while Meta, Broadcom and SpaceX turn to debt and equity for tens of billions. Private demand grew 4.9% and equipment investment 12.7% in Q3 GDP, confirming that spending continues; the debate is who finances it and at what cost. Morgan Stanley expects wider data-center ABS spreads and US corporate issuance is at an annual record.
A Fed that pauses but tightens: two votes to hike, 3.6% PCE and December nearly priced in	The FOMC held at 3.75%–4.00% with two votes in favor of a hike, and Warsh avoided explicit guidance. Q3 GDP grew 3.4% annualized (est. 3.2%) and PCE reached 3.6% (core 3.1% y/y), with third-quarter labor costs at 0.8% q/q, in line. Futures assign about 90% to a December hike and two officials said on Friday that higher rates are needed. Even so, the 10-year closed at 4.93%, below Wednesday's 5.05%: the safe haven worked again in the panic session, and the market is starting to distinguish between high rates due to inflation and high rates that punish tech credit. Gold gave up 2.7% to $3,899 (−3.7% on Friday) with a firm dollar. The 11/3 midterm election adds uncertainty about the term premium.
Central banks and sovereign debt: ECB, BoC and BoJ look at hikes while long bonds stay under stress	The ECB held rates with the French spread over the Bund near 150 bps after touching 178, and Bloomberg reports it is ready to hike if inflation does not ease; Lagarde leaves on February 7, with Hernández de Cos and Knot as favorites. The Bank of Japan held and declared its inflation goal met, the Bank of Canada hiked and the RBNZ is expected to hike in December. In the UK, Healey's budget tried not to frighten the 30-year gilts, which touched 6%, the highest since 1998. Meanwhile oil stayed conditioned by Hormuz: Brent touched $116.53 on Thursday after the attack on a tanker and closed the week at $113.43, and European gas topped €100/MWh, a point of inflationary pressure.
Argentina: Brazil contagion takes country risk to 765 and the Merval strings together five declines	After Lula's re-election and Brazil's worst session since 1999, the EMBI jumped from 707 to 765 bps on Monday and closed the week at 741 (+34 bps) on the last official reading. The MSCI Merval lost 10.0% in pesos and 10.7% in MEP dollars, with five down sessions; the global bonds fell (GD30D −1.66%, GD35D −2.91%) and the MEP rose 0.7% to $1,574, with a CCL of $1,681 on Monday and a 7.5% gap. The BCRA ended a 19-session buying streak and did not buy in three sessions, unprecedented this year, although the Treasury rolled over 106% of maturities and the IMF approved the third review at staff level for $900 million. January maturities ($4.5 billion) weigh, with the debt market closed and the GD35 yielding 11.9–12.6%, along with the debate over the low real exchange rate. Bonds price only a 50% chance of Milei's re-election in 2027.

4. Signals to Watch — Week of November 2–6

SIGNALS TO WATCH	
US midterm elections on Tuesday 11/3	PRISMA's model assigns 60.7% to a Democratic Senate and only 9% to a Republican trifecta, the scenario that would move the curve most: it would add about 28 bps to the 30-year bond, now at 5.32%. The risk does not end on Tuesday: Alaska recount (11/18), a possible Georgia runoff (12/1) and the new Congress on 1/3. Watch 5s30s, real rates and term premium.
Oil, Iran and Hormuz after the ballots	Brent trades near $113–116 and WTI above $100, with Vance's letter to Tehran on one side and the US warning to the Gulf of a short, intense renewal of the war after 11/3 on the other. Watch attacks on tankers and Saudi Arabia, European gas (TTF above €100) and government formation in Israel.
US data: Treasury refunding (11/4), October jobs (11/6) and new Fed voices	With December already priced in, Friday 11/6's jobs report and statements from the officials voting to hike will define whether the bet consolidates. The 11/4 refunding announcement will show whether the Treasury shortens its long-debt supply; rising long yields on a day when stocks fall would break the safe-haven thesis.
Europe and the UK: BoE (11/5), strike in France (11/5) and gilts	The Bank of England decides on Thursday 11/5 with inflation at 3.5% and gilts sensitive to the budget; France has a strike called for that date, with the spread over the Bund near 150 bps. A poor reception in gilts or OATs would spread to all rich-country debt and reinforce the rotation toward emerging markets.
Brazil and Argentina: finance minister, maturities and the central bank charter reform	In Brazil, the market awaits the finance minister's name and the fiscal signal for 2027 (deficit near 9.5% of GDP, debt above 82%). In Argentina, watch whether country risk consolidates the 740–760 range, the return of BCRA purchases, the CCL gap, the IMF Board and the Senate's handling of the central bank charter reform, which the lower house has already approved in committee.

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